Rodrigo Yañez Naudon

Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison
1180 Observatory Drive, Madison, WI 53706
yaeznaudon@wisc.edu · Website
Citizenship: Chile (F-1 visa)

References

Lones Smith (Advisor)
Professor
Department of Economics
UW–Madison
lones.smith@wisc.edu

Benjamin Bernard
Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
UW–Madison
bbernard3@wisc.edu

Daniel Quint
Professor
Department of Economics
UW–Madison
dquint@ssc.wisc.edu

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison May 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Economics. Advisor: Lones Smith

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile 2016
M.Sc. in Economics

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Valparaíso 2012
B.A. in Business and Economics

Research Interests

Microeconomic Theory, Dynamic Games, Information Economics, Industrial Organization

Job Market Paper

Dangerous Talk

I explore continuous-time partnerships in an organization. Each partner has a productivity-irrelevant hidden type, either normative or rogue. An exogenous public signal process gradually reveals partners' types to each other. The organization incentivizes calling out rogue types, but punishes false accusations. Opportunities to make an accusation or abandon the partnership arrive randomly, and are privately observed — so the partnership's very survival is an endogenous source of information. The equilibrium is unique when exit opportunities are sufficiently rare, and is characterize in terms of fear—exiting because of one's reputation—and openness—collaborating regardless of one's reputation. Lastly, I show that partnerships in this environment are assortative in the long run.

Publications

An Inexpert Expert (with Jose A. Carrasco and Martin Carrasco)
Applied Economics Letters, 30(18): 2613–2618, 2023.

Sequential Search and Firm Prominence (with Jose A. Carrasco)
Economic Theory, 74(1): 209–233, 2022.

Work in Progress

Silent Majorities
I study a dynamic model of self-censorship in which agents learn the social consensus only from voiced opinions. Because silence goes unobserved, learning is biased toward those who speak, giving rise to silent majorities.

Why Sell Loot Boxes? (with T. Fung Ngai)
A monopolist sells an indivisible good to risk-averse consumers with unit demand who share a common valuation but differ in wealth. By selling a lottery that delivers the good stochastically, the firm effectively makes the good divisible. When consumers can purchase the lottery repeatedly, they optimally choose their number of attempts and hence their overall probability of receiving the good. Richer consumers choose more attempts, so the repeated lottery screens consumers by wealth and can generate more revenue than does a posted price. This repeated lottery is nevertheless dominated by a menu of one-shot lotteries. We show that selling bundles of a virtual currency that consumers then spend on lotteries closes the gap, rationalizing why this selling scheme is prevalent in video games.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, University of Wisconsin–Madison

ECON 713: PhD Microeconomic Theory (first-year core) Spring 2023, 2024, 2025
ECON 711: PhD Microeconomic Theory (first-year core) Fall 2022
ECON 708: Microeconomics II (Master's) Spring 2022
ECON 701: Microeconomics I (Master's) Fall 2021, 2023, 2024

Instructor of Record, Universidad Técnica Federico Santa María, Chile

Microeconomics II (undergraduate) 2017–2019
Economics 1A (undergraduate) 2018–2019

Section Instructor, Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez, Chile

Principles of Economics (undergraduate) 2018

Professional Experience

Junior Consultant, Harrison y Johnson Asociados, Chile 2016–2019
Projects included:

- *Pricing design:* stock-market interconnection.
- *Institutional design:* competition-monitoring unit for the national electricity system operator.
- *Competition assessment:* interchange fees for instant fund transfers in banking.

Honors, Fellowships & Awards

JPGI Teaching Assistant Scholarship, UW–Madison Economics 2022–23
JPGI Summer Fellowship, UW–Madison Economics 2021–22, 2022–23

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent)